



ILLUSTRATION: Ram

Good things in life are free!

There's a treasure trove of free games lost in the vast expanse of the Net. Let's embark on an exploration to find these gems

Every gamer's wishlist would be made up of all the cool new games in the market, but buying them all simply isn't a feasible option. With prices ranging from Rs 500 to Rs 1,000 a game, only the insanely rich can feed such an expensive hobby.

If you can identify with this dilemma, then this article is just what you need. We'll tell you about the best in freeware games, where to get them, and why we think they're worth your time. While it might seem that the majority of the available freeware games are not worth your time, there are diamonds to be found if you look hard enough. We've filtered through the bandwidth wasters, and found the most addictive little puzzles, classics, and game modifications that are the perfect way to fill that void in your life before your next pay check/allowance rolls in.

Classic game remakes

It's amazing how far computer games have progressed in providing believable and immersive alternate worlds. But the classic games of the 1980s and early

1990s had something special about them. That was when gameplay reigned supreme, as there was no eye-popping graphics and digitised sounds to numb the senses. They just don't make them like they used to—the simpler, but more addictive games of yesteryear had their own personal edge in comparison to today's games that boast nothing but eye-candy.

All modern games have evolved

from classic games. An example of this is the timeless *Mario Brothers*, which evolved the arcade game genre ruled by classics such as *PacMan* and *Donkey Kong*. Games such as *Crash Bandicoot*, *Sonic the Hedgehog* and *Tomb Raider* have taken this genre a step further. And no one can deny that the legendary *Wolfenstein 3D* bought about a completely new genre in modern gaming, the 3D shooter. The great news is that

all your favourite classics, even those from the early 1980s, are available on the Internet, in both the original format as well as in the form of PC remakes.

For those who would like to play old school games of the ZX Spectrum, www.retro-spec.co.uk provides PC remakes of classic Spectrum games. These remakes improvise on the original and offer graphics and sound that the Spectrum did not offer back then. Some of these games are among the best ever written—*Jetpac*, *Trailblazer*, →



Classic games such as *Cybernoid* on the Spectrum have been remade for the PC